



भारतीय गुणवत्ता परिषद्
QUALITY COUNCIL®
OF INDIA
Creating an Ecosystem for Quality

Tender ref. no. QCI/0826/550

Dated: 06.08.2026

**Request for Proposal
for
Engagement of an agency for
Design, development, deployment, implementation,
and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and
Workflow Automation Platform for QCI**



QUALITY COUNCIL OF INDIA

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Tender Notice

1. Quality Council of India invites proposals for **“Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI”**
2. The content of this Request for Proposal (RFP) enlists the requirements of the QCI. It includes the Bidding Terms which details out all that may be needed by the potential bidders to understand the terms and bidding process and explain the contractual terms that the QCI wishes to specify at this stage.
3. After the submission of the Technical and Financial Proposals according to the instructions provided in the sections below, the bids will be evaluated through a two-stage process.
4. The Documents to be submitted:
 - A. The “Technical Bid” shall contain the following:
 - i. Form – 1, 2, 3 and 4 attached under Annexure-A
 - ii. All the documents required as per prequalification and technical evaluation criteria
 - iii. Any other details that the bidder may like to provide
 - B. The “Price Bid” shall contain the following:
 - i. The Vendors should submit the proposal as per the financial bid format through online mode only in relevant sections in GeM Portal (<https://gem.gov.in>)
 - ii. Taxes should be included in the above proposal.
5. The Technical Bids and Financial Bids may be submitted to GeM as per the guidelines.

Tender Summary

S. No.	Item	Details
1	Project Scope	Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI
2	Contract Duration	One (01) year and nine (09) months • Three (03) months – Complete deployment • Six (06) months – Warranty • One (01) year – Maintenance
3	Performance Bank Guarantee	5% of the Contract value
4	Proposal Selection	Quality & Cost Based Selection (QCBS)
5	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	₹ 1,60,000
6	Bid Validity	120 days
7	Last Date for Submission of Proposal	As per the GeM Bid.
8	Pre-bid Queries	To be submitted to procurement@qcin.org as per format given in Annexure-A .

I. INTRODUCTION

Quality Council of India (QCI)

QCI was established as an autonomous non-profit organization by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Govt. of India. QCI plays a pivotal role in propagating, adoption and adherence to quality standards in all important spheres of activities including education, healthcare, environment protection, governance, social sectors, infrastructure sector and such other areas of organized activities that have significant bearing in improving the quality of life and well-being of the citizens of India.

It functions through its five constituent Boards and Project Implementation Divisions to establish National Accreditation Program and Third-Party Assessment models with an aim to improve the quality ecosystem of the nation.

The various Boards are:

1. National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)

NABL has been established with the objective of providing Government, Industry Associations and Industry in general with a scheme of Conformity Assessment Body's accreditation which involves third-party assessment of the technical competence of testing including medical and calibration laboratories, proficiency testing providers and reference material producers.

2. National Accreditation Board for Hospitals & Healthcare Providers (NABH)

NABH is set up to establish and operate accreditation program for healthcare organizations. The board is structured to cater to much desired needs of the consumers and to set benchmarks for progress of health industry. The board while being supported by all stakeholders including industry, consumers, government, has full functional autonomy in its operation.

3. National Accreditation Board for Education and Training (NABET)

NABET has established a mechanism for the accreditation personnel certification, accreditation of vocational training organizations and skill assessment bodies. NABET also works in the domain areas of Education and Training. NABET works with various government departments for creating a credible model of assessment and provides its expertise to the departments to take credible decisions based on ground data.

4. National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB)

NABCB provides accreditation to Certification and Inspection Bodies based on assessment of their competence as per the Board's criteria and in accordance with International Standards and Guidelines. NABCB is internationally recognized and represents the interests of the Indian industry at international forums through membership and active participation with the objective of becoming a signatory to international Multilateral / Mutual Recognition Arrangements (MLA / MRA). NABCB is a member of the International Accreditation Forum (IAF) and its regional body Pacific Accreditation cooperation (PAC).

5. National Board for Quality Promotion (NBQP)

NBQP works on the vision of promoting quality of life for the citizens of India. It has two important missions; the first one is to promote application of quality management standards and statistical quality tools with an objective of enabling industry, to improve their competitiveness, with specific focus on SME sectors. The second mission is focused on empowering the consumers to demand quality and consequently creating a backpressure on suppliers to ensure quality of their products and service.

Besides the Boards there are Divisions which predominantly play a crucial role in implementing projects of the government or the industry:

1. Project Planning & Implementation Division (PPID)

This division works with various ministries in the government both at Central and State level. Set up with a vision of young professionals who could help the government from outside on key issues and provide support wherever required. PPID has worked with number of Ministries on projects, including (but not limited to) – Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, Ministry of Railways, NITI Aayog (erstwhile planning commission of India), Ministry of New and Renewable Energy, Department of Administrative Reform and Public Grievances (DARPG) and others.

2. NDIE Division

The Division leads various projects of National importance with a focus on 'Atmanirbhar Bharat'. The division is involved in flagship programs of Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Ministry of Tourism, Ministry of Defence, Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs and others.

3. Project Analysis and Documentation Division (PADD)

PADD aims towards the design, development, and implementation of voluntary conformity assessment frameworks for governmental, inter-governmental, regional, and global organizations.

4. Strategy and Policy Division (SPD)

SPD is driving force for transformative change, dedicated to achieving quality excellence for a developed India. By focusing on strategy and policy interventions, the SPD aims to strengthen India's quality infrastructure and ecosystem, positioning QCI as a global leader in quality transformation. The SPD is committed to developing and implementing innovative strategies to elevate the quality standards across various sectors, including manufacturing, services, and governance. Through collaborative partnerships and a proactive approach, the SPD seeks to create the world's most advanced quality ecosystem that supports India's development priorities and strengthens its position in the global economy.

II. BACKGROUND

Quality Council of India intends to onboard a technically qualified and experienced agency for the design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform.

The objective of this engagement is to establish a secure, scalable, and AI-enabled enterprise platform for intelligent knowledge management, information retrieval, and workflow automation across the organization.

The proposed solution should enable:

- AI-assisted search and retrieval of organizational information through natural language interactions
- Intelligent document processing and workflow automation for proposals, agreements, MoUs and other organizational documents
- Secure repository management with storage on QCI's Cloud system along with role-based access control, auditability, and data security
- Integration with existing enterprise systems through secure APIs.

The selected agency shall be responsible for end-to-end implementation including requirement analysis, solution architecture, development/customization, deployment, integration, testing, training, maintenance, operational support, and post-deployment handholding during the contract period.

The proposed solution should be modular, scalable, configurable and capable of supporting future enhancements, integration and evolving organizational requirements.

III. SCOPE OF WORK

The selected bidder shall be responsible for the design, development, deployment, implementation, integration, testing, operationalisation, maintenance and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub for Quality Council of India.

The scope of work shall broadly comprise the following four components:

Pillar 1: User Interface for QCI with Access Control

The bidder shall develop a secure, user-friendly and role-based web platform for authorized users of QCI.

The platform should provide:

- Secure user login and authentication mechanisms
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) for different categories of users
- User-specific and department-specific access permissions
- Dashboard-based access to repositories, workflows, and AI functionalities
- Conversational interface for AI-assisted interactions through text and/or voice inputs
- User activity tracking and audit logs
- Approval-based access provisioning and user management
- Integration with existing authentication systems such as SSO/LDAP/Active Directory, wherever applicable
- Administrative controls for user onboarding, offboarding and permission management

The interface should be scalable, responsive, configurable and designed for enterprise-level usage across QCI divisions and users.

Pillar 2: Knowledge Repository of Existing Documents

The bidder shall establish a centralised AI-enabled Knowledge Repository for storage in cloud server of QCI, indexing, organisation, retrieval and management of organisational documents and datasets.

The repository should support:

- Ingestion of structured and unstructured documents including PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPT/PPTX, and scanned documents (not handwritten) with only digital typefaces
- OCR-enabled extraction of content from scanned documents
- Metadata tagging, indexing, classification, categorization, and document versioning
- Department-wise, project-wise, and user-specific repository structures
- Searchable document repositories with contextual retrieval capabilities
- Repository-level access control and document visibility restrictions
- Audit trails for uploads, downloads, edits, sharing and deletion activities
- Secure storage and retrieval mechanisms with backup and recovery support
- Integration with existing document repositories i.e. file servers

The repository should support both organisation-wide shared repositories and restricted user-specific repositories with configurable permissions.

Pillar 3: AI-Enabled Outputs

The bidder shall develop AI-enabled capabilities for intelligent information retrieval, workflow automation and document generation using organisational repositories and contextual enterprise data.

The platform should support:

- AI-assisted search and retrieval of organisational information through natural language queries
- Citation-backed and evidence-based responses linked to source documents
- Intelligent summarisation, contextual search and document analysis
- AI-assisted drafting and generation of:
 - Proposals
 - MoUs
 - Agreements
 - Work Orders
- Workflow-based document review, approvals, and iterative refinement
- Context-aware document generation using organisational repositories and user inputs
- Prevention of unsupported or hallucinated outputs to the extent technically feasible
- Export of outputs in editable formats such as DOCX/PDF
- Logging, traceability and auditability of AI-generated outputs and interactions

The AI-enabled solution should be modular, configurable, secure, scalable and capable of supporting future enhancements and integrations in later phases, multilingual capabilities, and evolving organisational requirements.

Pillar 4: Deployment, Operations & Support

The selected bidder shall be responsible for deployment, testing, operationalisation, maintenance, and support of the proposed platform during the contract period.

The scope under this component shall include but not be limited to the following:

- Deployment of the platform in the approved infrastructure environment
- System Integration Testing (SIT), User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Performance Testing and Security Testing
- Bug fixing, issue resolution and pilot deployment support
- Production rollout, go-live stabilisation and support
- Preparation of deployment documentation, operational manuals and technical documentation
- Application support and incident management
- Support API-based integration capabilities for future enterprise integrations
- Performance optimisation and preventive maintenance
- Security patching and minor enhancements/configuration support
- SLA-based helpdesk support and operational assistance
- Periodic reporting, monitoring, and operational reviews
- Generation of usage reports, analytics dashboards and system activity reports

The bidder shall ensure adherence to defined uptime, response timelines, resolution timelines and service levels as specified elsewhere in the RFP.

Timelines:

- 3 months for deployment
- 6 months warranty
- Post go-live, we may parallelly go on to enhance the system for which 2 AI engineers not less than 3 years of experience will be need to work on the system on need basis. A maximum of 160 man-days (80 each) shall be allotted for the same. The payment for these enhancements shall be on T&M basis for a period of 6 months concurrent with warranty period.
- Annual Maintenance Cost post warranty period billed quarterly in advance

Data Ownership, Portability and Exit Management

The proposed solution shall be designed and implemented in a manner that avoids vendor lock-in and ensures long-term operational flexibility for Quality Council of India.

The selected bidder shall ensure that:

- QCI retains full ownership of the platform, all organisational data, repositories, documents, generated outputs, configurations, workflows and related metadata
- The platform supports standard data export, backup, migration, and interoperability mechanisms
- Adequate technical documentation, configuration details, API documentation, deployment architecture and operational manuals are provided to QCI
- Transition and handholding support shall be provided during exit/termination or migration scenarios, if required by QCI
- No proprietary restrictions shall prevent QCI from migrating to another platform, service provider or infrastructure environment in future.

The bidder shall ensure reasonable portability, continuity, and transition support for the deployed solution throughout the contract period and during project closure/exit management activities.

Deliverables

This defines all measurable parameters of every deliverable. This is a binding part of the scope.

S. No.	Category	Deliverable/Parameter	Quantity/Specification
A. Deployment & Coverage			
1	Deployment	Mode	In QCI AWS environment, single environment
2	Deployment	Environments included	Production + UAT
3	Deployment	Geographic data residency	Within an organisation's on-prem network
4	Coverage	Concurrent user support	Any number of users deemed necessary (initially 100)
B. Document Ingestion			
5	Ingestion	Supported file types	PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PPT/PPTX, scanned PDFs/images, excluding handwritten
6	Ingestion	Max file size per upload	200 MB
7	Ingestion	Per-user Repo quota	10 GB; can be revised using admin controls
8	Ingestion	OCR accuracy benchmark (printed text)	≥ 90%-character accuracy
9	Ingestion	Initial bulk corpus ingested in Phase 1	Up to 10,000 documents or 2 TB, whichever is higher
C. Query Interface			
10	Query	Input modes	Text + voice (voice transcribed before processing)
11	Query	Output mode	Text only
12	Query	Citations per response	Mandatory; minimum 1 per factual claim
13	Query	Conversation history retention per user	90 days
14	Query	Voice languages supported (input)	English, Hindi, Hinglish
D. RBAC & Tagging			
15	RBAC	Role types supported	Super Admin Power User, Board/Division Admin User, Standard User
16	RBAC	Audit log retention	12 months online + archive thereafter
E. Workflow Automation			
17	Workflow	Document types covered	Proposal, MoU, Agreement, Work Order

**TENDER DOCUMENT FOR ENGAGEMENT OF AN AGENCY FOR DESIGN, DEVELOPMENT, DEPLOYMENT, IMPLEMENTATION, AND
SUPPORT OF AN AI-POWERED KNOWLEDGE HUB AND WORKFLOW AUTOMATION PLATFORM
TENDER REF. NO. QCI/0826/550**

S. No.	Category	Deliverable/Parameter	Quantity/Specification
18	Workflow	Templates per document type included	3 organisation-standard template each (12 total)
19	Workflow	Output formats	.docx
20	Workflow	Versioning	Auto-versioned (v1, v2, v3...)
21	Workflow	Clarifying questions	Asked before draft finalisation
F. HR Database Ingestion			
22	HR DB	Ingestion type	Batch Ingestion
23	HR DB	Refresh frequency	Monthly
24	HR DB	Fields consumed	Name, ID, qualifications, experience years, current bandwidth %, project history, availability date, location
25	HR DB	Access control	Tender/Proposal authors only; gated by RBAC role
G. Guardrails			
26	Guardrails	Citation completeness	100% of factual claims must carry a citation
27	Guardrails	"No information found" behaviour	Explicit user-facing message; logged for admin review
28	Guardrails	"Access denied" behaviour	Explicit user-facing message; logged for admin review
H. Admin Dashboard			
29	Dashboard	Document version retention	Last 3 versions per document, full history archived
30	Dashboard	Audit log export formats	CSV
I. Operations & SLAs			
31	Warranty	Duration of operational support	6 months from go-live
32	Uptime	Platform availability	99% monthly (excluding planned maintenance)
33	Uptime	Downtime remedy	Submit report for the Downtime Incident
34	Helpdesk	Channels	Phone, email, in-app ticket
35	Helpdesk	Hours	9 AM – 9 PM IST, Mon–Sat
36	Helpdesk	Response SLA, P1 (platform down)	30 minutes
37	Helpdesk	Response SLA, P2 (major feature broken)	2 hours
38	Helpdesk	Response SLA, P3 (general query)	1 working day
39	Bug fixes	Resolution SLA, Critical	1 working day
40	Bug fixes	Resolution SLA, Major	5 working days

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S. No.	Category	Deliverable/Parameter	Quantity/Specification
41	Bug fixes	Resolution SLA, Minor	15 working days
42	Reporting	Monthly operating report	Delivered by the 7th of the following month
43	Template tweaks	Per document template type per quarter	Up to 2 minor tweaks
J. Training			
44	Training	Admin training sessions	3 sessions × 2 hours
45	Training	End-user training sessions	4 sessions × 90 minutes (cohort-based)
46	Training	Format	Live online + recorded library + user manual
47	Training	Languages of training	English + Hindi
K. Acceptance & QA			
48	QA	UAT duration	4 weeks
49	QA	Acceptance criteria, Pillar 1	Functional pass + RBAC test suite pass + guardrail benchmarks met
50	QA	Acceptance criteria, Pillar 2	Functional pass + draft quality review on 10 sample inputs per template
51	QA	Revision rounds, content/templates	2 rounds per template included
52	QA	Revision rounds, platform features	2 rounds per module included
53	QA	Beyond included rounds	Treated as change requests
L. Security & Compliance			
54	Security	Encryption at rest	AES-256
55	Security	Encryption in transit	TLS 1.2+
56	Security	Authentication	SSO via SAML/OIDC + MFA
57	Security	Audit logging	All queries, uploads, permission changes, and document generations
58	Security	Vulnerability patching cadence	Critical within 7 days; Major within 30 days
59	Security	Penetration testing	One pre-go-live pen test included; subsequent tests are change requests
60	Compliance	DPDP Act 2023 alignment	Data handling aligned to DPDP requirements
M. IP, Data & Post-Engagement			
61	IP	Platform IP	Owned by the organisation
62	IP	Templates	Owned by the organisation
63	IP	Generated documents	Owned by the organisation

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S. No.	Category	Deliverable/Parameter	Quantity/Specification
64	IP	Foundational AI model licensing	Open-source models under their respective licenses; vendor-licensed components disclosed during Phase 1
65	Data	Document and query data ownership	Owned by the organisation; never leaves the on-prem environment
66	Post-engagement	Extension option	Available at mutually agreed-upon commercials
67	Post-engagement	Knowledge transfer	4-week handover to the organisation's IT team if engagement is not extended

IV. PREQUALIFICATION CRITERIA

S. No.	Particulars	Specific Requirements	Documents Required
1.	Legal Entity	The Bidder(s) interested in participating in the Selection Process must be a duly registered legal entity in India, under any one of the following categories: - - A Limited Liability Partnership ("LLP") registered under the LLP Act, 2008. - An Indian Company ("Company") registered under the Companies Act, 1956/ 2013; - A "Partnership Firm" registered under the Indian Partnership Act, 1932.	Registration documents of the Bidder as a company/firm or any legal entity along with: - Incorporation Certificate of the company - PAN Card of the registered legal entity - GST certificate of the registered legal entity - Certified copy of registered Partnership Deed; copy of Statement filed in the Register of Firms disclosing names, addresses and relevant details of ALL partners of the Partnership Firm - MSME Certificate (if applicable) - Cancelled Cheque - Any other supporting document, as may be required
2.	Average Annual Turnover	Average annual turnover of at least ₹ 3.2 crores generated in each of the past three (3) financial years (2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26).	- Turnover certificate by CA (original); or - Audited financial statements P&L plus balance sheet for the last three financial years (i.e. 2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26). to support the claim
3.	Experience	The Bidder(s) must have relevant experience of Enterprise AI Systems, AI enabled platforms, Knowledge management systems, Workflow automation systems, Intelligent document processing, Enterprise search, Controversial AI, Forward deployed AI engineering, or similar digital transformation assignments for Central or State Govt., UT, PSU, universities, autonomous bodies and private organizations in India, in the last five (05) financial years as per following:	- Contract/ Agreement/ Work Orders/ Work Completion - Certificate from client(s) clearly states the details of the scope of work, date of commencement, details of the assignment on the client's letterhead signed by the issuing authority providing the details of the project/contract. - The document should clearly define the scope of work, value of the order, and duration of the order.

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		- At least one work order of ₹ 64 lakhs, OR - At least two work orders of ₹ 48 lakhs, OR - At least three work orders of ₹ 32 lakhs	
4.	Non-Blacklisting	The bidding entity must not be blacklisted / terminated / debarred by any state or central government or their agencies and should not have been found guilty of any criminal offence by any court of law, in the last three (3) years.	As per format in Form 4 of Annexure-A signed and stamped on company letterhead

Interested Bidders submitting their proposals are expected to meet the above pre-qualification criteria. In case any Bidder fails to either meet all these criteria or does not furnish the requisite supporting documents/ documentary evidence in support thereof, the bid is liable to be summarily rejected.

Note: In case agency bound by any Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) clause and not able to submit the work order copy, redacted version of the Documents can be submitted masking name of the party however the Document should clearly mention the nature of work performed, contract value, duration of contract

V. EVALUATION CRITERIA

Evaluation of the bids will be done in two stages namely Technical Evaluation (comprising pre-qualification check and technical presentation) and financial evaluation based on QCBS basis. The technical evaluation shall be based on the following criteria:

S. No.	Criteria	Max. Marks
1.	Understanding of Project Requirements and Objectives - Complete Understanding of the proposed Scope of Work – 15 marks - Limited Understanding of the proposed Scope of Work – 10 marks - Only basic Understanding of the proposed Scope of Work – 5 marks - No Understanding of the proposed Scope of Work – 0 marks	15
2.	Approach, methodology, and Demonstration: A description of the approach, and methodology for performing the assignment covering the following subjects: - AI Capabilities & Workflow Automation Features - 5 marks - Deployment, Integration & Implementation Methodology - 5 marks - Knowledge Repository & Document Management Capabilities - 10 marks - Demonstration / Proof of Concept (PoC) of solution proposed - 10 marks	30
3.	Experience: Case study for five (05) relevant assignments of Enterprise AI Systems, AI enabled platforms, Knowledge management systems, Workflow automation systems, Intelligent document processing, Enterprise search, Conversational AI, Forward deployed AI engineering, or similar digital transformation assignments (<i>for which work orders have been submitted in technical bid</i>) in the past 5 financial years for Central or State Govt., UT, PSU, universities, autonomous bodies and private organizations in India - 5 marks per case study	25
4.	Team Composition CVs of key personnel deployed for the assignment (<i>should include CVs of 2 AI engineers to be deployed for enhancement</i>)	20
5.	Deployment and handover plan	10
Technical Score		100

Note:

1. *Minimum marks for technical qualification are 70 out 100.*
2. *The bidder that abstains from attending the technical presentation round will be disqualified.*

VI. METHOD OF SELECTION

1. The bids shall be evaluated on Quality and Cost Based Selection (QCBS).
2. In deciding the final selection of the service provider, the technical bid for the proposal will be given a weightage of 70% and the financial bid will be given a weightage of 30%. (in case of QCBS)
3. The financial bids of only those bidders who qualify for the technical evaluation will be invited. (in case of QCBS)
4. The proposal with the lowest cost will be given a score of 100 and the other proposals will be scored on a pro-rata basis, inversely proportional to the cost offered, i.e., lower marks for higher priced offers. (in case of QCBS)
5. Subcontracting may be allowed only upon prior written intimation to QCI at the Bidding stage itself, the responsibility for management and liability shall rest with the selected service provider.

TOTAL SCORE: (in case of QCBS)

- The total score shall be obtained by weighing the quality and cost scores and adding them.
- Total Score = [Normalised Technical Score* 0.70 (Weightage given to technical criteria)] + [Financial Score* 0.30 (Weightage given to financial criteria)].

VII. TERMS & CONDITIONS

1. **Contract Duration:** The contract will be assigned for a total period of one (01) year and nine (09) months wherein three (03) months will be for complete deployment; six (06) months for warranty and one (01) year for maintenance, which may be extended further, subject to satisfactory performance of the service provider on the same terms & conditions and the requirements of QCI.
2. **Amendments to RFP:** At any time prior to the last date for receipt of applications, QCI may, for any reason, whether at its own initiative or in response to a clarification requested by a prospective applicant, modify the RFP document by an amendment. In order to provide prospective applicants with reasonable time to take the proposed amendments into account while preparing their proposals, QCI may at its discretion extend the last date for the receipt of proposals and/or make other changes in the requirements set out in the RFP. Any such amendment shall be communicated to the service providers.
3. **Authorization of Signatory:** The Bid may be signed either by the Principal Officer of the service providing firm or his duly Authorized Representative, in which case he/she shall submit a certificate of authority. All certificates and documents (including any clarifications sought and any subsequent correspondence) received hereby, shall, as far as possible, be furnished and signed by the Representative or the Principal Officer. The Principal Officer/ authorized representative of the firm shall sign the proposal and initial all pages of the original Technical Proposal. The authorization shall be in the form of a written power of attorney accompanying the Proposal or in any other form demonstrating that the representative has been duly authorized to sign. The power or authorization, or any other document consisting of adequate proof of the ability of the signatory to bind the Bidder shall be annexed to the Bid.

4. **Warranty:** The Service provider confirms and warrants to QCI that commencing from the date of Go-Live and for a period of twelve (12) months thereafter, (the "Warranty Period") the web portal (including software and hardware components as well as any materials, subsystem embedded in the System), shall operate and perform to the maximum extent of its capabilities and in all respects in strict accordance with the terms and the conditions of this RFP and be free of any malfunctions, faults, defects and/or deficiencies, including but not limited to any malfunctions, faults, defects and/or deficiencies with respect to: design, material, workmanship, assembly, materials, components, software, hardware, etc.) ("Warranty"). The Service provider further confirms and warrants that, as an integral part of the Warranty Period, the Service provider shall provide to QCI, without any additional charge or cost, with regular, preventive, corrective and emergency maintenance services for the System and any part thereof, which services shall include, inter alia, support, labor, calibrations, support and examination of the System, repairs, replacements, updates, troubleshooting and correction of bugs, as well as all applicable manufacturer specifications in order to assure that the web portal and any part thereof, shall operate and perform to the maximum extent of its capabilities.
5. **Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)/ Bid Security:** Bidders shall submit, along with their Bids, Bid Security (EMD) of ₹ 1,60,000 as per the details mentioned below:

- By demand draft in favor of Quality Council of India, payable at New Delhi, and physical copy to be sent to QCI office (Procurement unit), Tower J, 3rd floor, World Trade Center, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi – 110029, or
- Deposit through RTGS/ NEFT as detail under:

Name of the Bank	Axis Bank LTD, 6/83, Padam Singh Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi
Name of the Account	Quality Council of India
Saving Bank Account	223010100053020
IFSC Code	UTIB0000223

Note:

- i. NO CHEQUES WILL BE ACCEPTED. The applicant whose EMD has been deposited by NEFT/RTGS, must enclose the transaction details/ evidence along with their technical bid, otherwise the bid will be rejected.
- ii. Bid security in any other form will not be entertained.
- iii. No interest will be payable to the Bidder on the amount of the EMD. Unsuccessful Bidder's EMD will be discharged/ returned as promptly as possible, but not later than 45 days of completion of the process
- iv. In case bid is submitted without the bid security then QCI reserves the right to reject the bid without providing opportunity for any further correspondence to the bidder concerned. The EMD may be forfeited:
- v. If a bidder withdraws its bid during the period of bid validity.
- vi. Bidder does not respond to requests for clarification of its Proposal.
- vii. Bidder fails to provide required information during the evaluation process or is found to be nonresponsive.
- viii. In the case of a successful bidder, if the bidder fails to sign the contract in accordance with this RFP.

MSEs (Micro and Small) and DPIIT registered startups are exempted from paying Earnest Money Deposit. In this case participants are required to submit valid MSE registration certificates (Udyam Registration certificate) or DPIIT startup certificate to avail exemption. **MSEs with trading as major activity will not be allowed exemption for payment of EMD.**

6. EMD Refund:

- a) **For Unsuccessful Bidders:** The EMD of all unsuccessful bidders would be refunded without interest by QCI on finalization of the bid in all respects by the successful bidders within 45 days after finalization of tender.
- b) **For Successful Bidders:** The EMD of successful bidders would be returned without interest upon submission of Performance Bank Guarantee by the successful bidders. The abovementioned refund would be completed within 30 days of the submission of PBG by the successful bidder. In case a bid is submitted without the bid EMD then QCI reserves the right to reject the bid without providing opportunity for any further correspondence to the bidder concerned.

7. Performance Bank Guarantee: QCI shall require the selected service provider to provide a Performance Bank Guarantee, within 30 days of the notification of award, for a value equivalent to 5% of the contract value, with validity period for the contract duration. The Performance Guarantee shall contain a claim period of three months beyond the expiry of its validity.

The selected bidder shall be responsible for extending the validity date and claim period of the Performance Guarantee as and when it is due on account of non-completion of the submission of deliverables. The selected vendor can submit e-PBG OR physical copy of Performance Guarantee should be submitted at QCI-HO within 30 days from the notification of award. The selected bidder would be required to send SFMS code while creating PBG to the IFSC code provided by QCI. In case the selected bidder fails to submit a Performance Guarantee within the time stipulated, the purchaser at its discretion may cancel the order placed on the selected bidder without giving any notice. Purchasers shall invoke the performance guarantee in case the selected bidder fails to discharge their contractual obligations during the period or purchaser incurs any loss due to bidder's negligence in carrying out the project implementation as per the agreed terms & conditions.

8. Presentation: As a part of evaluation of proposals submitted by the applicants, QCI shall seek further information or a presentation from the organizations for evaluation purposes. QCI may call for such information/ presentation at short notice. The presentation link shall be sent to only those bidders who qualify the prequalification criteria.

9. Ownership Rights: Ownership of all new artifacts (data, reports, presentations and other publications) generated during the assignment or otherwise with respect to the assignment, will rest with QCI and it will have the right to resell/ implement the same with any other organization.

10. Payment Terms:

- i. The payment will be made as per following schedule:

Milestone	Deliverable	% of one-time cost
M1	Sign-off of requirement study, solution architecture & project plan (SRS + design document)	10%
M2	Development & configuration of Pillars 1–3 complete, integrations built, and successful System Integration Testing (SIT)	20%

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M3	Successful UAT sign-off + Performance & Security testing (including the pre-go-live penetration test) cleared	25%
M4	Production go-live with initial bulk corpus ingested (up to 10,000 docs / 2 TB) and go-live stabilization completed	20%
M5	Completion of admin & end-user training, handover of documentation/operational manuals, and issue of Final Acceptance Certificate (FAC)	15%
M6	Release on satisfactory completion of the 6-month warranty period	10%

Annual Maintenance cost: Payment shall be made on quarterly advance basis.

Resource cost: Payment shall be based on monthly basis after QCI-sign off on actual number of man-days utilized.

- ii. Payment shall be made within 30 days of receipt of tax invoice complete in all respect and QCI project team sign-off.
- iii. Incorrect Invoices, Under/Over Payment: In case an invoice is found to have been rendered incorrectly after payment, any underpayment or overpayment will be recoverable by or from the Service provider, as the case may be, and, without limiting recourse to other available means, may be offset against any amount subsequently due by QCI to the Service provider under this contract.

11. Conflict of Interest:

- i. The bidder shall not have a conflict of interest that may affect the Selection Process, or the work envisaged under this RFP (the "Conflict of Interest"). Any Applicant found to have a Conflict of Interest shall be disqualified.
- ii. QCI requires that the Service Provider provides professional, objective, and impartial advice and at all times holds the QCI's interest paramount, avoid conflicts with other assignments or its own interests, and act without any consideration for future work.
- iii. The Service Provider shall not accept or engage in any assignment that would be in conflict with its prior or current obligations to other clients, or that may place it in a position of not being able to carry out the assignment in the best interests of the QCI.
- iv. In the event that a Service Provider identifies a potential conflict of interest, they shall make a disclosure to QCI as soon as any potential conflict comes to their notice but in no case later than 7 (seven) days from the receipt of such proposals and any breach of this obligation of disclosure shall be construed as Conflict of Interest. QCI shall, upon being notified by the Service Provider under this Clause, decide whether it wishes to terminate this service or otherwise, and convey its decision to the service provider within a period not exceeding 15 (fifteen) days.

- 12. **Fraud/Corruption:** QCI requires that the bidders participating in the selection process adhere to the highest ethical standards, both during the selection process and throughout the execution of the Contract. In pursuance of this policy, QCI defines, for the purpose of this paragraph, the terms set forth as applicable to both the parties:

- i. "Corrupt practice" means the offering, giving, receiving, or soliciting, directly or indirectly, of anything of value (whether in cash or kind) to influence the action of a public official in the selection process or in Contract execution.
- ii. "Fraudulent practice" means a misrepresentation or omission of facts in order to influence a selection process or the execution of a Contract.
- iii. "Collusive practices" means a scheme or arrangement between two or more bidders with or without the knowledge of QCI, designed to establish prices at artificial, non-competitive levels.
- iv. "Coercive practices" means harming or threatening to harm, directly or indirectly, persons or their property to influence their participation in a procurement process or affect the execution of a Contract. QCI will reject a proposal for award if it comes to know that the bidder recommended for award has, directly or through an agent, engaged in corrupt, fraudulent, collusive or coercive practices in competing for the Contract in question; and
- iv. QCI will terminate the Contract, if already awarded and will declare the bidder ineligible, either indefinitely or for a stipulated period of time, to be awarded a Contract, if at any time it determines that the bidder has, directly or through an agent, engaged in corrupt, fraudulent, collusive or coercive practices in competing for, or in executing, a Contract.

13. Termination of Contract:

i. Termination for Default

QCI reserves the right to terminate / short close the contract, without prejudice to any other remedy for breach of contract, by giving 15 days' notice if the Service Provider fails to perform any obligation(s) under the contract and if the Service Provider, does not cure their failure within a period of 15 days (or such longer period as QCI may authorize in writing) after receipt of the default notice from QCI.

ii. Termination for Insolvency

QCI may at any time terminate the contract by giving written notice without compensation to the Service Provider, if the Service Provider becomes bankrupt or otherwise insolvent, provided that such termination will not prejudice or affect any right of insolvent, provided that such termination will not prejudice or affect any right of action or remedy which has accrued or will accrue thereafter to QCI.

iii. Termination for Convenience

QCI may, with a written notice sent to Service Provider, terminate the contract, in whole or part, at any time for its convenience, by giving 15 days' notice. However, the payment shall be released to the extent to which performance of work executed as determined by Service Provider till the date upon which such termination becomes effective.

- iv. The Service Provider may terminate this contract, or any Services, by giving 15 days' written notice to QCI, if the Service Provider reasonably determines that the Service Provider can no longer provide the Services in accordance with applicable law or professional obligations.

14. The bidder should adhere to laws of land and rules, regulations and guidelines prescribed by various regulatory, statutory and Government authorities which are applicable to respective business, obligations and subject matters of the contract. QCI reserves the right to conduct an audit / on-going audit of the services provided by the bidder. QCI reserves the right to ascertain information from organizations to which the bidders have rendered their services for execution of similar projects.

15. **Intellectual Property Rights/Interventions:** QCI will own all the intellectual property resulting out of services being performed under this contract.

“Intellectual Property and Invention” includes documents, reports, concept papers, ideas, concepts, creations, discoveries, inventions, improvements, know-how, trade or business secrets; trademarks, service marks, designs, utility models, tools, devices, models, methods, procedures, processes, systems, principles, algorithms, works of authorship, flowcharts, drawings, books, papers, models, sketches, formulas, teaching techniques, electronic codes, proprietary techniques, research projects, and other confidential and proprietary information, computer programming code, databases, software programs, including their source code; data, documents, instruction manuals, records, memoranda, notes, user guides; in either printed or machine readable form, the whether or not copyrightable or patentable, or any written or verbal instructions or comments.

“Intellectual Property Rights” or “IPRs”/ “Inventions” include (i) all rights, title and interest under any statute or under common law including patent rights; copy rights including moral rights; and any similar rights in respect of Intellectual Property, anywhere in the world, whether negotiable or not; (ii) any licenses, permissions and grants in connection therewith; (iii) applications for any of the foregoing and the right to apply for them in any part of the world; (iv) right to obtain and hold appropriate registrations in Intellectual Property and, (v) all extensions and renewals thereof (vi) Causes of action in the past, present or future, related thereto including the rights to damages and profits, due or accrued, arising out of past, present or future infringements or violations thereof and the right to sue for and recover the same.

The Service Provider may use data, software, designs, utilities, tools, models, systems and other methodologies and know-how (“Materials”) that the Service Provider owns in performing the Services. The Materials (including any improvements or knowledge developed while performing the Services), and in any working papers that are developed in the course of the Services shall rest with QCI. The Service Provider shall not use any such Materials included in the Reports, as well as the Reports themselves without the prior permission of QCI.

On completion of the project, all documents, SOPs, reports, dashboards, data etc. collected and prepared by the Service Provider as a part of the contract, shall be transferred to QCI.

16. **Language:** The Proposal should be filled by the bidders in English language only. If any supporting documents submitted are in any language other than English, translation of the same in English language is to be duly attested by the Bidders. For purposes of interpretation of the documents, the English translation shall govern. All correspondence and documents relating to the Proposal exchanged by the bidder and QCI shall also be written in the English language.
17. **Standard of Performance:** The consultant agrees to perform services diligently, efficiently, and economically, adhering to professional standards and practices. They will act as faithful adviser to QCI, prioritizing the QCI's interests in all dealings with third parties.
18. **Companies' Personnel:** The service provider shall employ and provide at its own cost such qualified and experienced audit personnel as are required to carry out the Services. Their salaries, claims, insurance, damages, compensation, travel etc. will be the liability of the service provider(s) and QCI will in no way be responsible for any such claims/ damages.
19. **Training:** The service provider shall organize user training upon completion of the development phase and shall facilitate a smooth handover and transition of the system by the user department.

20. **Limitation of Liability:** The total aggregate liability of the Service Provider, whether arising from breach of contract, or any wrongful act other than a breach of contract (including negligence), breach of statutory duty, or otherwise, in connection with this Agreement, shall not exceed an amount equal to five (5) times the total fees paid or payable to the Service Provider under this Agreement.
21. **Ethics:** QCI expects all assessors, Service Provider to show highest ethical standards during the course of the assignment; if any complaints/information regarding any incident of bribery, corrupt payment, an unauthorized offer etc., is brought to the fore, the Service Provider shall take the necessary action (to the extent of expulsion/removal) as per its organization rules and laws applicable at that time; QCI is absolved of any liability/claim arising out of any such above situations; all personnel should have signed the code of conduct with the Service Provider and any conflict of interest shall be declared to QCI.
22. **Penalty for delay in execution of project:** If the successful bidder does not complete the project within the stipulated period given in the Scope of Work, a penalty at the rate of 0.25% per week of the corresponding Purchase Order value will be levied for a maximum period of ten weeks.
- However, cumulative delay beyond ten-week period will be sufficient cause for termination of the Agreement. In which case Performance Bank Guarantee paid by the service provider may be forfeited subject to prior notice and opportunity of being heard.
23. The contract will be awarded to the service provider whose proposal conforms to this RFP and is, in the opinion of QCI, the most advantageous and represents the best value to the assignment, price and other factors considered.
24. **Written Undertakings:** QCI may at any time require the Service Provider and its employees/advisors/professionals/ contractors, to whom confidential information may be disclosed in the course of execution of contract, to give a written undertaking in the form of a deed reasonably accepted to QCI and relating to the use and non-disclosure of the confidential information relating to QCI or any Government Department or relating to any Ministry and or such other information that QCI suggests to be confidential. Upon receiving a request aforesaid the Service Provider must promptly arrange for all such undertakings to be given to QCI.
25. **Non-compete:** During the term of this Agreement and for a period of two (2) years following its termination or expiration, whichever is earlier, the Service Provider agrees not to directly or indirectly engage in, provide services to, or have any financial interest in any business or enterprise that provides services similar to those provided to QCI to any client of QCI ("QCI Client"). The geographic scope of this non-compete obligation shall extend to India.
- Notwithstanding the foregoing, the Service Provider shall be permitted to engage in activities that do not directly compete with the services provided by QCI to its Clients.
- The Service Provider acknowledges and agrees that the non-compete obligations are necessary to protect the legitimate business interests of the Company, including its confidential information and client relationships.
26. **Security:** The Service Provider shall not disclose the details of this Contract with any third party at any point of time unless required by law. That the Service Provider and its employees/professionals/personnel are only authorized to access the information shared and/or collected under this project and no third party shall have any access to any information either written or oral without the written consent of QCI.

The Service Provider shall ensure that all the data collected and processed and information received under this project or during the execution of this project and or required to be shared with QCI, by the Service Provider under this Contract shall be in totally secure mode and that the Service Provider shall take all necessary steps to prohibit any unauthorized sharing/publishing of data in the public domain or with any other party or person who is not authorized by QCI to receive such information and or data. That the Service Provider shall ensure that all the data collected, and information received under this contract shall be used only for the purpose of execution of this contract and once the purpose of this contract is fulfilled then all the papers, drawings, notes, memoranda, manuals, specifications, designs, devices, documents, diskettes, CD's, DVD's. Tapes, Trade Secrets and any other material on any media containing or disclosing any confidential or proprietary technical or business information shared during the course of execution of this contract shall be returned to QCI.

27. **Data Ownership & Usage Restrictions:** All data collected, generated, processed, or stored on the LMS platform in connection with QCI's subscription, including but not limited to learner personal data, training records, assessment responses, behavioral analytics, usage patterns, course content, and organizational data, is the exclusive property of QCI and shall be used solely for the purpose of delivering services under this contract.

The vendor, its employees, subcontractors, affiliates, and parent entity are expressly prohibited from: (a) using QCI data for any internal purpose including product improvement, AI or ML model training, algorithm development, or benchmarking; (b) sharing, licensing, selling, or disclosing QCI data to any third party; (c) using anonymized, aggregated, or derived versions of QCI data for any commercial purpose.

28. QCI reserves the right to accept or reject any bid, to annul the entire bid process or reject all bids at any time prior to award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected service provider(s) or any obligation to inform the affected service provider(s) of the grounds for such decision. QCI also reserves the right to negotiate with the successful service provider, if necessary.
29. **Subcontracting:** There must be no further subcontracting without prior written consent of QCI; all manpower deployed by the Service provider shall be on-roll employees of the Service provider or must have a direct employment contract with the Service provider.
30. **Maintenance of Confidentiality:**
- i. The bidder(s) must not divulge any confidential information and assure that reasonable steps are taken to provide for the safe custody of any confidential information in its possession and to prevent unauthorized access thereto or use thereof. The shortlisted bidder(s) must not, without the prior written consent of QCI, disclose any confidential information of QCI or any government department or relating to any ministry or any other party. In giving written consent to the disclosure of confidential information, QCI may impose such conditions as it thinks fit, and the bidder must comply with these conditions. Confidentiality clause shall survive for a longer period of one year after the termination of contract or contract expiry period.
 - ii. **The selected agency will be required to sign a mutually agreed Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) with QCI.**

iii. No part of this document, including the Annexure, can be reproduced in any form or by any means, disclosed or distributed to any person without the prior consent of QCI, except to the extent required for submitting the bid. The information contained in this document is only disclosed for the purpose of enabling potential service providers to submit a proposal to QCI. This document should not therefore be used for any other purpose. These documents contain proprietary information furnished for evaluation purposes only; except with the written permission of the QCI, such information may not be published, disclosed, or used for any other purpose. The bidding firms acknowledge and agree that this document and all portions thereof, including, but not limited to, any copyright, trade secret and other intellectual property rights relating thereto, are and at all times shall remain the sole property of QCI. The title and full ownership rights in the information contained herein and all portions thereof are reserved to and at all times shall remain with QCI. service providers must agree to take utmost care in protecting the proprietary and confidential nature of the information contained herein.

31. **Removal of Data:** The Service Provider must ensure that its employees/ professionals' subcontractors and/ personnel do not:

- i. remove any data or allow any data concerned with this contract to be removed from the places as notified/directed by QCI; or
- ii. take any data or allow any data to be taken outside of India, without QCI's prior written consent.

32. **Force Majeure:** Neither party shall be held responsible for non-fulfillment of their respective obligations due to the exigency of one or more of the force majeure events such as but not limited to Acts of God, war, flood, earthquakes, strike, lockouts, epidemics, pandemics, riots, civil commotion etc., provided on the occurrence and cessation of any such events. The affected party thereby shall give notice in writing to the other party within one week of such occurrence or cessation. If the force majeure conditions continue for over six months, the parties may then mutually decide about the future course of action.

Force Majeure shall not include:

- i. any event which is caused by the negligence or intentional action of a Party or by or of such Party's agents or employees, nor
- ii. any event which a diligent Party could reasonably have been expected both to take into account at the time of the signing of the Contract and avoid or overcome with utmost persistent effort in the carrying out of its obligations hereunder.
- iii. Insufficiency of funds or manpower or inability to make any payment required for execution of services under this Contract.

33. **Access by QCI:**

- i. The QCI may, at all reasonable times and on giving reasonable notice to the Service Provider access the premises of the Service Provider to the extent relevant to the performance of this contract; require the provision by the Service Provider, its employees, personnel or professionals agents of records and information in a data format and storage medium accessible by the QCI by use of the Service Provider existing computer hardware and software; inspect and copy documentation, books and records, however stored, in the custody or under the control of the Service Provider, its employees, agents, professional or personnel; and require assistance in respect of any inquiry in to or concerning the Services or this Contract.

- ii. For these purposes an inquiry includes any audit whether administrative or statutory review 'audit or inquiry (whether within or external to the Department), any request for information directed to the QCI by any authority or Government Department or any Ministry and any inquiry conducted by Parliament or any Parliamentary committee.
 - iii. The Service Provider must provide access to its computer hardware and software to the extent necessary for the Service Provider to exercise its rights under this clause, and provide QCI with any reasonable assistance requested by the Service Provider to use that hardware and software provided that any proprietary information including confidential information like profit margins, overheads and other such confidential information about its employees, sub-contractors, organization would not be made available.
34. During evaluation, QCI may, at its discretion, ask the respondents for clarifications on their proposals. The firms/agencies are required to respond within the time frame prescribed by QCI.
35. QCI may at its sole discretion and at any time during the evaluation of proposal, disqualify any respondent, if the firm:
- i. Submitted the proposal after the response deadline
 - ii. Made misleading or false representations in the forms, statements and attachments submitted in proof of the eligibility requirements
 - iii. Exhibited a record of poor performance such as abandoning works, not properly completing the contractual obligations, inordinately delaying completion or financial failures, etc. in any project in the preceding three years.
 - iv. Submitted a proposal that is not accompanied by required documentation or is non-responsive, failed to provide clarifications related thereto, when sought
 - v. Submitted more than one proposal
 - vi. Was declared ineligible by the Government of India/State/UT Government for corrupt and fraudulent practices.
36. **Knowledge transfer:** Subject to any qualification or provision to the contrary in the statement of work, the Service Provider must provide the following assistance to the QCI on termination or expiration of this Contract: transferring or providing access to the QCI to all information stored by whatever means held by the Service Provider or under the control of the Service Provider in connection with this Contract; and making Specified Personnel / employees and Service Provider Personnel available for discussions with the QCI as may be required. The time, length and subject of these discussions will be at the sole discretion of the QCI, provided that any matter discussed is not considered to reveal any 'commercial-in-confidence information of the Service Provider.
37. **Indemnity:** Service Provider undertakes to indemnify QCI from any losses that QCI may incur due to any deficiency in services rendered by Service Provider or any instance of corruption or improper payment.
38. **Deployment of Technical Resources:** The Service Provider shall provide the technical and other staff during the execution of this project depending upon the requirement of work. The technical staff should be available at their own offices, QCI offices and whenever required for discussions and to take instructions.
39. **Taxes & Duties:** The service provider shall be liable to pay all direct and indirect taxes, duties, fees and other impositions levied under the laws of India.

40. **Rescinding of Work order:** The work order issued by QCI to Service Provider for the above scope can be withdrawn at any time by giving a notice period of 7 days if an Service Provider fails to perform/execute work as per the requirements specified in this document after two warnings (served in writing) or in case of non-compliance/breach of any of the terms and conditions of this order.
41. **Validity of Proposals:** The proposals remain valid for a period of 120 days from the last date of submission. In exceptional circumstances, QCI may solicit the bidder's consent to an extension of the period of validity. The request and the responses thereto shall be made in writing. A bidder consenting to such request shall not be required nor permitted to modify its Proposal.
42. QCI, by issuance of this RFP does not necessarily indicate or imply that the project will be commenced. The service provider will absolve QCI of all responsibilities if the project does not start within a stipulated time frame. QCI reserves the right to withdraw this assignment any time without prior consultation or intimation to the service provider.
43. The service provider shall not make any alteration / changes in the bid after the closing time and date. Unsolicited correspondence from the service provider will not be considered.
44. The service provider shall be deemed to have complied with all clauses in this RFP. Evaluation shall be carried out on the available information in the bid and QCI is not liable to seek clarifications on the documents not submitted as part of the bid.
45. The firms / agencies submitting their proposals would be responsible for all of its expenses, costs and risks incurred towards preparation and submission of their proposals, attending any pre- proposal meeting and visiting the site or any other location in connection therewith. QCI shall, in no case, be responsible or liable for any such costs whatsoever, regardless of the outcome of the process.
46. **Disclaimer:** QCI shall not be responsible for any late receipt of applications for any reasons whatsoever. The applications received late will not be considered. QCI reserves the right:
 - i. To reject any/all applications without assigning any reasons thereof.
 - ii. To relax or waive any of the conditions stipulated in this document as deemed necessary in the best interest of the QCI without assigning any reasons thereof.
 - iii. To include any other item in the Scope of work at any time after consultation with applicants or otherwise
 - iv. To adopt method deemed fit to evaluate the proposals
 - v. To select multiple Service Provider for the project for allocation of work in different areas if it meets the essential criteria for qualification.

VIII. SUBMISSION OF PROPOSALS

The bidder is expected to prepare proposals covering the following aspects:

1. **Technical Bid:**
 - i Signed and stamped Form-1, 2, 3 and 4 attached as Annexure-A
 - ii EMD details
 - iii Supporting documents for the details required as per pre-qualification criteria
 - iv Supporting documents for the details required as per technical evaluation criteria.
 - v Any other details that the bidder may like to provide.

2. Financial Bid:

S. No.	Particulars	Quantity	Rate (exclusive of taxes)	Amount (exclusive of taxes)
1	One-time cost for design, development, deployment, implementation and support (inclusive of 6 months warranty)	L/S	-	
2	Resources for enhancement of system for 6 months (80 man-days per engineer for 2 AI engineers)	1280 (2 x 80 x 8)	<per man hour per engineer >	
3	Annual Maintenance cost	12 months	<per month>	
	Total Cost (exclusive of taxes)			
	Taxes			
	Total Cost (inclusive of taxes)			This total to be quoted as the offer price on the GeM portal

Additional Notes:

- i. 1 Man-day = 8 hours
- ii. Taxes must be itemized separately as per applicable government rates.
- iii. Ensure clarity on resource loading and service hours.
- iv. Please mention the following in preparing your bid:
 - Dated this [date / month / year]
 - Authorized Signatory (in full and initials)
 - Name and title of signatory
 - Duly authorized to sign this proposal for and on behalf of [Name of service provider, Name of the Firm, Address of the Firm]

3. Submission Details:

- i. The Financial and Technical Proposals should be submitted separately in the given format and signed by the Authorized Signatory. Financial bid, if submitted along with the technical bid, is liable to be rejected.
- ii. In case the bidder submits financial bid not as per the format mentioned in this RFP document or further corrigenda, it will lead to basis for disqualification.
- iii. All the pages of the proposal must be sequentially numbered and must contain the list of contents with page numbers. Any deficiency in the documentation may result in the rejection of the Bid.
- iv. All pages of the application shall be signed and stamped by the authorized signatory.
- v. Please Note that Prices must not be indicated in the Technical Bid.

For any queries, you may contact the following:

Procurement Team, QCI

Email id: procurement@qcin.org

Annexure-A

Form 1: Covering letter with the Proposal in response to RFP Notice

(To be submitted on the Letterhead of the responding firm)

To,

Deputy Director (Finance & Accounts),
Quality Council of India,
World Trade Centre, J 200, Block J,
Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Subject: Submission of proposal in response to the RFP for **“Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI”**.

Dear Sir,

1. Having examined the RFP document, we, the undersigned, herewith submit our proposal in response to your RFP for **“Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI”**, in full conformity with the said RFP document.
2. We attach our technical response and our financial quotation in separate sealed cover as required by the RFP, both of which together constitute our proposal, in full conformity with the said RFP.
3. We undertake, if our proposal is accepted, to adhere to assign a team dedicated to this project.
4. We have read the provisions of RFP and confirm that these are acceptable to us. We further declare that additional conditions, variations, deviations, if any, found in our proposal shall not be given effect to.
5. We undertake, if our proposal is accepted, to adhere to the scope of engagement or such modified plan as may subsequently be mutually agreed between us and QCI or its appointed representatives.
6. We agree to unconditionally accept all the terms and conditions set out in the RFP document and also agree to abide by this bid response for a maximum period of 120 days from the date fixed for bid opening and it shall remain binding upon us with full force and virtue, until within this period a formal contract is prepared and executed, this bids response, together with your written acceptance thereof in your notification of award, shall constitute a binding contract between us and QCI.
7. We affirm that the information contained in this proposal or any part thereof, including its exhibits, schedules, and other documents and instruments delivered or to be delivered to through this proposal is true, accurate, and complete.
8. This proposal includes all information necessary to ensure that the statements therein do not in whole or in part mislead the QCI as to any material fact. We agree that QCI is not bound to accept the lowest or any bid response you may receive. We also agree that you reserve the right in absolute sense to reject all or any of the products/ service specified in the bid response without assigning any reason whatsoever.

It is hereby confirmed that I/We are entitled to act on behalf of our corporation/company/firm/organization and empowered to sign this document as well as such other documents, which may be required in this connection.

Dated this Day of (Year) (Signature) (In the capacity of)

Duly authorized to sign the Bid Response for and on behalf of:

(Name and Address of Company)

Seal/Stamp of Bidder

Form 2: Relevant Project Experience for completed projects

S. No.	Name of the Project/ Engagement	Client Name	Duration (Period)	Approximate value of the assignment

Form 3: Details of the responding firm

Section No.	S. No.	Particular	Detail
I		COMPANY PROFILE:	
	1.	Name of the Organization * (As appearing on PAN Card)	
	2.	Registered Office Address *	
	3.	SPOC for the bid submitted:	
		Name:	
		Mobile no.:	
		Email Address:	
	4.	Address for Billing Office*	
		Name of Contact Person *	
		Contact No. *	
		Mobile No.	
		E mail ID *	
	5.	Name of Contact Person (Finance & Accounts) *	
		Contact no.	
		Mobile no.	
		E mail ID *	

II		STATUTORY DETAILS:	
	1.	GST Details (Attach GST certificate): -	
		Whether Registered Assessee (Yes or No)	
		If Yes: -	
		GSTIN Number # *	
		Type of Assessee	
	2.	MSME	
		Whether Registered under MSME (Yes or No) *	

TENDER DOCUMENT FOR ENGAGEMENT OF AN AGENCY FOR DESIGN, DEVELOPMENT, DEPLOYMENT, IMPLEMENTATION, AND SUPPORT OF AN AI-POWERED KNOWLEDGE HUB AND WORKFLOW AUTOMATION PLATFORM

TENDER REF. NO. QCI/0826/550

		If Yes (Attach MSME certificate): -	
		MSME Registration No. and validity date # *	
	3.	Permanent Income Tax No. (PAN) # (Attach PAN)	
	4.	NATURE OF ENTITY: * PROPRIETOR/PARTNERSHIP/ LPP/ PRIVATE LIMITED /PUBLIC LIMITED/GOVERNMENT	
	5.	WHETHER FUNCTIONING IN A SPECIAL ECONOMIC ZONE. (SEZ) (Yes/ No) *	

III	BANK DETAILS (Attach Cancelled cheque): -		
		Name of Bank	
		Address of Bank	
		Bank Account No.	
		IFSC Code	
		SWIFT CODE (If party's billing address is outside India)	

IV	Details of responding Company		
1.	Current Year Turnover (Rs Crores)		
2.	Company Profile (Operations in India)		
2.1	Average turnover from Indian Operations	(Turnover in Rs Crores)	
2.2	Full-time professional staff engaged in related services	(Number of Staff)	
2.3	Extent of operations in India (national spread) i.e. number of offices in India (client specific / project specific offices should not be taken into account)	(Number of Offices in different cities/towns and their address)	
3.	Company Experience		
3.1	Experience of providing similar services		(Number of clients and their brief description)

Declaration by Director/ Proprietor/ Partner:

I/We declare that the information furnished above is correct to the best of my/our knowledge / belief. I/We undertake to inform you of any change in above particulars at the earliest.

Dated this Day of (Year)

(Signature) (In the capacity of)

Duly authorized to sign the Proposal Response for and on behalf of: (Name and Address of Company) Seal/Stamp of Bidder

Form 4: Format for Non-Blacklisting Undertaking

(To be submitted on the Letterhead of the responding firm)

To,
Deputy Director (Finance & Accounts),
Quality Council of India,
Institution of Engineers Building,
2nd Floor, 2, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg,
New Delhi-110002

Subject: Non-Blacklisting declaration in connection with RFP Ref. No. _____ dated _____ for “**Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI**”

Dear Sir,

This is to notify you that our Firm/Company/Organization _____ intends to submit proposal in response to invitation for Tender Ref. No. _____ for “**Engagement of an agency for design, development, deployment, implementation, and support of an AI-powered Knowledge Hub and Workflow Automation Platform for QCI**”. In accordance with the above, we declare that:

- a. We are not involved in any major litigation that may have an impact of affecting or compromising the delivery of services as required under this agreement
- b. We are not blacklisted by any Central/ State Government/ agency of Central/ State Government of India or any other country in the world/ Public Sector Undertaking/ any Regulatory Authorities in India or any other country in the world for any kind of fraudulent activities.

Dated this Day of (Year)

(Signature) (In the capacity of)

Duly authorized to sign the Proposal Response for and on behalf of:

(Name and Address of Company) Seal/Stamp of Bidder

Format for Pre-bid query form

S. No.	Clause no., Page no.	Original clause in RFP document	The point on which Clarification required	Reason for amendment (if any)

Bidders are required to submit their queries as per the above format on their letter head duly signed and also share the word file of the above to the procurement@qcin.org within 1 day from the date of conducting of pre-bid meeting.